FLOOR, NOT CEILING

With the Right Policy Scaffolding, We Can Build More Battersea Miracles.

Land Talks · Bill Chen

150,000

trips per week

25,000

new jobs

20,000

new homes

1,400

Apple staff

How the £1.1bn was repaid



£660m business rates uplift

£270m developer contributions

GLA bond cover

Four conditions stacked

1

42 acres
1 landowner

2

Commercial anchor

Apple · US Embassy · Frasers

Four conditions stacked

3

Enterprise Zone

25-year rates retention

4

Willing risk-bearer

Greater London Authority

Pull any one out — the model collapses

THE PRINCIPLE

Tax the land value that infrastructure creates, to pay for the infrastructure.

HK$10.3bn

MTR property profits, 2024

The metro substantially funds itself.



The principle scales.

Hong Kong | Copenhagen | Tokyo | Singapore

Mature economies. Property markets like ours.

Britain just hasn't built the scaffolding.

1991

Last council tax revaluation

35 years frozen

Uplift goes private

Existing homes never rebanded → all uplift stays private

Treasury can't commit 25-year revenue → every project bespoke

Battersea every time.

Today's patchwork

S106

CIL

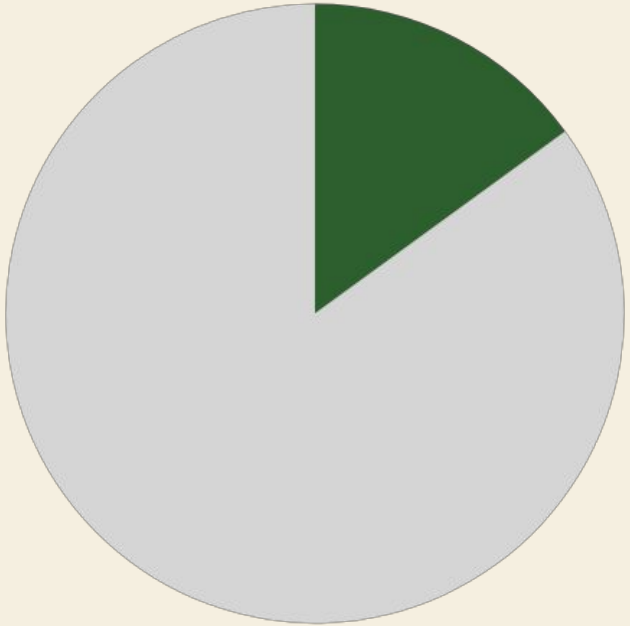
Business rates retention

Enterprise Zones

MCIL

SDLT

Each captures a slice



What we capture today

What's actually there

S106 · CIL · Business rates · Enterprise Zones · MCIL · SDLT

LAND VALUE TAX

One tax. All beneficiaries. All uplift.

+ standardised hypothecation +
integrated delivery

How it works

All beneficiaries → one tax → infrastructure



Affordable housing at Battersea



originally promised

actually built

250 affordable homes lost to viability negotiation

The window is open



Oct 2025:
HCLG calls
for reform

Mar 2026:
Govt response

2026+:
Window open

£9bn /year

potential capture
(CPP estimate)

What reform doesn't unlock

- HS2 — uplift too diffuse
- East-West Rail — too linear
- Social infrastructure — no land value created

These need general taxation.

What reform unlocks

Today

2-3

Battersea-class candidates

After reform

15-20

candidate pipeline

Estimate · £20-30bn over a decade · ~4% of the 10-Year Strategy

FLOOR, NOT CEILING.

Reform the scaffolding. Battersea becomes the floor.

£20bn unlocked · without a penny more from the Treasury

Land Talks · Bill Chen